transfers have struggled, requiring a change in course. In 2023, agreements on jet engines and drones, among others, were concluded and involved much higher rates of technology transfer. But they represent only a beginning of what could still be a much better developed defence–technological partnership.

Japan represents another important emerging security partnership for India in the Indo–Pacific. The two countries began to normalize relations in 2000 after India's nuclear tests. Both New Delhi and Tokyo harboured similar concerns about China's rise and military assertiveness, and were equally worried about the future of the United States' security commitment to the region. For Tokyo, India is vital for securing sea lines of communications, upon which Japan's commercial interests and energy security are dependent. Due to the absence of historical baggage associated with Japan's role in World War II, India has been useful in helping to normalize Japan's military power and expanding its security role outside its immediate region. In the early 2000s, the two countries embarked upon some tentative anti-piracy operations and coast guard exercises. In 2001, a security dialogue was institutionalized and operational cooperation increased after the 2004 Indian Ocean tsunami.

India–Japan strategic relations took off in 2006 under the prime ministership of Shinzo Abe. In 2008, the two countries agreed to a Joint Declaration on Security Cooperation and initiated staff talks between the maritime forces. In 2010, a 2+2 dialogue involving the foreign and defence ministries was established. Bilateral naval exercises were held, somewhat belatedly, in 2012. Relations gradually extended to staff college talks, port calls, and participation in fleet reviews. In 2014, Abe was chief guest at India's Republic Day, which was significant in that the ceremony includes a military parade. Over the subsequent years under Abe and Modi, coordination on freedom of navigation in the South China Sea and on North Korea increased, Japan was permanently included in the Malabar naval exercises, a civilian nuclear agreement was signed and brought into force, and agreements were concluded to facilitate the sharing of classified information and defence technologies. Ground and air force exercises were